

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: The State-Theory Problem and Its Stakes

CENTRAL FOCUS

The State-Theory Problem and Its Stakes

[1] State theory asks about origin, purpose, liberty, inequality, society and change.

|

v

[2] Gauba compares competing images rather than announcing one final state doctrine.

|

v

[3] The state appears as ethical whole, instrument, class relation and group coordinator.

|

v

[4] A theory becomes misleading when its partial insight is treated as exhaustive.

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v

VERDICT -> State theory is plural because political power has several dimensions.

ANSWER USE -> Name the dimension before selecting or combining perspectives.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Definitions and the Chapter Sequence

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Definitions and the Chapter Sequence

[1] Organic theory treats the state as natural; contract theory treats it as artificial.

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v

[2] Laissez-faire limits the state, while welfare liberalism makes freedom enabling.

|

v

[3] Marxist, communitarian and post-colonial views relocate the source of political power.

|

v

[4] Gandhian, feminist and pluralist views challenge coercion, patriarchy and monopoly.

|

v

VERDICT -> Definitions locate each perspective before evaluation begins.

ANSWER USE -> Contrast the image of the state, not only the thinker's name.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: The Six-Test Comparison Grid

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The Six-Test Comparison Grid

[1] Origin asks whether the state is natural, contracted, class-produced or colonial.

|

v

[2] Purpose compares good life, rights, welfare, class rule, swaraj and coordination.

|

v

[3] Liberty ranges from obedience through non-interference to capacity and self-rule.

|

v

[4] Inequality, civil society and route to change complete the mandatory six-test grid.

|

v

VERDICT -> The six-test grid converts a list of theories into disciplined comparison.

ANSWER USE -> Apply the same dimensions to every perspective in the answer.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Organic, Contract and Liberal Thinkers

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Organic, Contract and Liberal Thinkers

[1] Aristotle, Burke and Hegel develop natural, historical and ethical state images.

|

v

[2] Hobbes, Locke and Rousseau use contract for security, rights and popular sovereignty.

|

v

[3] Smith, Bentham, James Mill, Spencer and Nozick defend different limited-state arguments.

|

v

[4] J.S. Mill, Green, Hobhouse, Laski and MacIver revise liberalism toward welfare.

|

v

VERDICT -> Liberal traditions disagree internally about authority, rights and welfare.

ANSWER USE -> Separate contract, minimal-state and positive-liberal arguments.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Critical, Communitarian, Gandhian, Feminist and Pluralist Thinkers

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Critical, Communitarian, Gandhian, Feminist and Pluralist Thinkers

[1] Marx, Engels and Lenin explain class rule; Gramsci adds coercion and hegemony.

|

v

[2] Miliband argues instrumental capture; Poulantzas answers with bounded relative autonomy.

|

v

[3] Communitarians stress embedded selves; post-colonial theory stresses inherited state forms.

|

v

[4] Gandhi, Millett, Eisenstein and pluralists expose coercive, gendered and dispersed power.

|

v

VERDICT -> Critical theories differ over class, community, empire, coercion and gender.

ANSWER USE -> Use one internal debate before moving across traditions.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Ten-Perspective Comparative Matrix

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Ten-Perspective Comparative Matrix

[1] Ten perspectives must be compared through the same six dimensions, not merely listed.

|
v

[2] Organic and contract views prioritise ethical whole and authorised protection differently.

|
v

[3] Minimal, welfare and Marxist views disagree about liberty, property and structural power.

|
v

[4] Communitarian, post-colonial, Gandhian, feminist and pluralist lenses widen the agenda.

|
v

VERDICT -> Each perspective illuminates one state function and obscures another.

ANSWER USE -> Compare attraction, mechanism and strongest limitation together.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Trap Repair, Boundaries, Revision and Sources

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Trap Repair, Boundaries, Revision and Sources

[1] Reject the claims that all contract theorists, liberals or feminist thinkers agree.

|
v

[2] Keep Miliband distinct from Poulantzas and Millett distinct from Eisenstein.

|
v

[3] Locke's text was largely composed before 1688 but later read as vindicating the settlement.

|
v

[4] Pluralism disperses power but does not prove equal groups or a neutral state.

|
v

VERDICT -> Precision depends on resisting false mergers and unsafe historical claims.

ANSWER USE -> Turn every common misconception into an explicit correction.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Theses, Directives and Marxist Argument Reconstruction

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Theses, Directives and Marxist Argument Reconstruction

[1] A rigorous thesis identifies which state image and which comparison dimension matter.

|
v

[2] Directive control prevents liberalism, Marxism or feminism from being flattened.

|
v

[3] Miliband's personnel and leverage claim meets Poulantzas's structural-autonomy objection.

|
v

[4] Relative autonomy remains bounded if the account is to retain a Marxist explanation.

|
v

VERDICT -> Relative autonomy explains mediation without making class power irrelevant.

ANSWER USE -> Present claim, objection and bounded reply in that order.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Named Evidence and Mark-Scaled Architecture

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Named Evidence and Mark-Scaled Architecture

[1] Aristotle, Locke, Macaulay, Miliband and Poulantzas supply named evidence units.

|

v

[2] Millett and Eisenstein provide distinct feminist routes into state criticism.

|

v

[3] Solidarity and Eastern European environmental groups illustrate associational pressure.

|

v

[4] Mark-scaled answers move from one pair to cross-cluster comparison and internal debate.

|

v

VERDICT -> Named texts and cases must perform an analytical role, not decorate the answer.

ANSWER USE -> Link evidence to one comparison dimension and one limitation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Indian Application and Proposition Method

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Indian Application and Proposition Method

[1] India's post-colonial state combines inherited institutions with a new legitimating order.

|

v

[2] The 1-2 July 2026 e-Governance conference illustrates service and capacity-building.

|

v

[3] AI-enabled administration also raises surveillance, access, neutrality and accountability issues.

|

v

[4] Use current evidence to test perspectives, not to declare one theory finally correct.

|

v

VERDICT -> Digital governance can express welfare capacity and intensify domination risks.

ANSWER USE -> Apply several lenses without treating a current programme as proof.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: MCQ Remediation and Trap Repair

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MCQ Remediation and Trap Repair

[1] Close options test natural versus artificial state and negative versus positive liberty.

|

v

[2] They also test state above society versus state within society.

|

v

[3] Thinker groups must not erase Hobbes-Locke-Rousseau or Miliband-Poulantzas differences.

|

v

[4] Every correct option should identify perspective, mechanism and theoretical limit.

|

v

VERDICT -> Close options are separated by state image, freedom concept and power location.

ANSWER USE -> State the decisive distinction before selecting an answer.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: PYQ Ownership and Answer Practice

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PYQ Ownership and Answer Practice

[1] No directly owned verified UPSC PYQ is assigned to this Political Theory topic.

|
v

[2] Six original questions cover comparison, internal debate and agenda-widening critiques.

|
v

[3] A strong answer applies the six-test grid and one named objection-reply pair.

|
v

[4] Final recall: no single image exhausts the state's ethical, coercive and social roles.

|
v

VERDICT -> Original practice preserves ownership while testing the complete theory grid.

ANSWER USE -> Conclude by naming which lens best answers the question's demand.